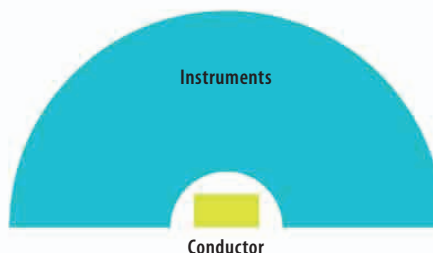


The conductor

A conductor guides members of an orchestra or choir through a musical work to achieve an accurate and effective interpretation. Conductors have individual styles, using fine movements or large gestures depending on the type of music.

Why do we need conductors?

After 1800, as compositions became more complex and their rhythms and speeds more flexible, it became necessary to have a conductor. Orchestras are now larger, making it difficult for players to hear one another. The conductor gives visual cues for the players to follow, making the overall performance unified.



◁ **Conductor's position**
Most conductors stand in the center on an elevated rostrum, or podium, so that they can easily be seen by the performers.

SEE ALSO

◀ 24–25 Beats and measures

◀ 30–31 Time signatures

◀ 32–33 Compound time

What is the score?

194–195 ▶

The conductor's score

As well as choosing the music that the orchestra plays, the conductor also studies the musical score in advance, marking instructions on it to convey to the orchestra during a rehearsal. Some conductors memorize these instructions, using no score in concerts.

▽ Section of score

In the score of the opening of "Sinfonia Concertante for Violin and Viola," Mozart places the solo instruments between the orchestral oboes and horns and orchestral strings.

Allegro maestoso

Oboes

Horns

Violin

Viola

Violino I.

Violino II.

Viola I.

Viola II.

Violoncello.

Contrabasso.

Orchestral strings

Sustained horns, one octave apart

Staccato notes in solo violin

Staccato notes in orchestral first violins

Sixteenth note broken chords in second violins

Lower string silent